

The implications of artificial intelligence in management consulting: A risk and barrier assessment



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Abstract In the world of management consulting, a looming question is whether artificial intelligence will replace management consultants or not or perhaps not entirely. However, the field of management consulting is likely to undergo dramatic changes in the near future. Based on more precise pattern recognition, artificial intelligence can assist management consultants in resolving issues, creating value, maximising growth, and improving business performance. Management consultants provide objective advice and expertise using their business skills, and assist an organization in developing any specialist skills that it may lack. Artificial intelligence can assist management consultants in generating structures, performing data analytics quickly and serving as a personal and data assistant. As artificial intelligence (AI) has advanced rapidly in recent years, many applications have been developed in management consulting. Enhancing the productivity of management consulting could be one of the most economically and socially beneficial uses of artificial intelligence. Through the use of artificial intelligence (AI), management consulting companies and individual consultants may be able to grow, innovate, and meet global challenges in an accelerated manner. As a career, management consulting can be one of the most rewarding and satisfying in terms of both remuneration and job satisfaction. The use of artificial intelligence in management consulting can, however, pose some security and ethical challenges which are discussed in this paper.

Keywords: consulting automation, AI implementation, future trends, consulting framework, organizational disruption

1. Introduction & Background

Many organizations show great interest in artificial intelligence (AI), but when it comes to actual implementation a lot of them have trouble or fail (Vial et al., 2023). Using machine learning, probabilistic methods, natural language processing, and neural networks together can be used to perform tasks, analyze data, and discover patterns that repeat over time. Given the burgeoning investments in AI, management consultants should start treating AI as an integral tool for their core business operations. Educating employees, modernizing their technology infrastructures, and focusing on overall data quality can help management consulting firms succeed. An integrated approach to managing customer data will enable companies to gain insight into customers' behavior and make the most of their data. A strategic approach is required to integrate artificial intelligence into business management (Feuerriegel et al., 2022). As artificial intelligence (AI) becomes more widely used, it will contribute greatly to the solution of problems and the introduction of new operational processes within businesses. In the past few years, artificial intelligence has become more popular as a result of its ability to optimize operations, reduce working time, and improve quality (Gînguță et al., 2023). A significant influence of digital transformation on business model innovation has been seen in global management consulting firms (Tavoletti et al., 2022). In terms of both individual and organizational benefits, artificial intelligence (AI) is a promising technology (Al-Qudah, 2022). With Artificial Intelligence (AI), management consulting can be more efficient, data-driven, personalized, and predictive. It's important to emphasize aspects like responsiveness and resilience in the design process (Chiou & Lee, 2022). Risk management is being reshaped by artificial intelligence (Naim, 2022). The consulting industry might get transformed by artificial intelligence, not threatened by it. AI solutions need a qualitative approach to ensure legitimacy (Vianello et al., 2023). In order to take advantage of its rapid growth, you'll need to adapt and upskill, but there's also plenty of room for those who want to take advantage. Organizations must address inscrutability and data dependency when implementing AI (Weber et al., 2023).

The management consulting industry is one of the oldest and most well known specialized consulting services in the world (Mohan, 2024) that is equally used by the private sector and the government. In the course of the years, consulting professionals have acquired a wide range of subject matter expertise, including Finance, Information and Communications Technology, Management, Business Transformation, Quality Management, Organizational Development, Marketing, Operational Management, Economics, Human Resources Management, Technology Management, Business Transformation,



Quality Management, and Emerging Technologies. With the advancement of artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) technology and the evolution of technology consulting paradigms for development, management consulting has evolved quickly over the past three decades as a profession (Vial et al., 2023). As AI and machine learning technologies evolve and develop, they will impact the way insights are arrived at by management consultants. They will also impact how decisions are made, as well as the organization models and structure of organizations in some way. As a result of advancements in technologies, the author investigates what challenges, new opportunities, and potential changes are going to be faced by management consultants as a result of these developments (Mindell & Reynolds, 2023). There have been rapid advances in artificial intelligence capabilities, particularly in relation to management consulting, which have increasingly intersected with the processes and deliverables of management consultants in recent years. There are a number of challenges that management consulting firms and individuals must contend with as a result of this development, including reskilling and developing new value propositions for their clients. Taking advantage of the rapid developments in AI capabilities in the last few years, consulting firms and professionals can seek to embrace the use of AI in the consulting process in order to maximize the value to clients that can be derived from the human and machine partnership in consulting.

2. Understanding the Implications of AI on Management Consulting Model

As information technology grows, artificial intelligence is increasingly using both data and processing power. This is to produce outputs that look like they have been composed by a human management consultant. Artificial intelligence (AI) has been getting a lot of attention lately for its impact on overall management and operations. With the integration of artificial intelligence into management consulting, professionals will be able to benefit from deeper analytics and predictive capabilities that will assist them in making more informed, data-driven decisions. With respect to AI's application and impact, the question is whether it will replace or augment human labor. In previous research, artificial intelligence tools have been shown to enhance the decision-making process of humans rather than replacing it with machine learning algorithms (Noponen, 2019). Through the use of a new modeling approach, the ethical implications, risks, and challenges associated with artificial intelligence in business consulting have been examined. The study of artificial intelligence provides insight into how artificial intelligence can be used to solve problems and introduce new operational procedures in a business (Gingută et al., 2023). Almost all industries have been revolutionized by technology and technological advances have had a significant impact on management consultants in several ways.

Consulting as a profession dates back thousands of years (Mische, 2017), while artificial intelligence has only been around for a few decades. Every industry, including management consulting, is introducing innovative ideas (Tavoletti et al., 2022). Due to global challenges such as climate change, post-pandemic challenges, dwindling economies and population growth, as well as the scarcity of resources, these innovations are becoming increasingly important. The introduction of artificial intelligence in management consulting solves many challenges and reduces many disadvantages of traditional consulting. In the near future, artificial intelligence will be available everywhere, and organizations of all sizes are already embracing the technology at varying levels. Figure 1 shows how artificial intelligence can be used to effectively manage change in management consulting by integrating it into the process of analysis and evaluation. Figure 1 focuses on how AI-driven tools and processes make it possible for consultants to adapt to dynamic environments, enhance decision making, and improve client outcomes by allowing them to adapt to dynamic environments. In an effort to create competitive advantage and create value for stakeholders, enterprises are investing heavily in the use of artificial intelligence to disrupt business models (Mohan, 2024). There is a growing awareness among businesses that they need to mature to become AI-powered in order to succeed. In recent years, more companies have been experimenting with artificial intelligence, advancing their data capabilities, acquiring new technologies and talent, and incorporating AI into their business processes, which presents inherent challenges in managing their data. The connection between data and artificial intelligence is extremely strong. It is a common challenge faced by management consulting organizations that they have to overcome resistance to change. A number of reasons may contribute to employees' aversion to new technologies such as artificial intelligence, including a fear of the unknown, concerns about job security, and a general aversion to change (Oarue-Itseuwa, 2024). The key to overcoming resistance is effective communication, stakeholder engagement, and addressing employees' concerns and misconceptions in order to overcome resistance.

3. Understanding the Implications of AI on Management Consulting Model

Technology may prompt changes, but it also changes the way change management is conducted as a result of the evolution of technology. With the use of artificial intelligence (AI), organizational change no longer has to be restricted by the structure of the organization. Talent is more likely to be employed virtually, switch in and out of consulting projects as needed, and AI technology will be used to make this possible, allowing talent to be brought into a consulting project more fluidly (Laker et al., 2021). Consequently, the approach to change will be more agile as a result of this process. We live in a world where data is at the center of everything we do. In the field of management consulting, organizations can use data to obtain thorough insights into every step of the consulting process, from understanding the needs of clients and leveraging analytics to gaining

deep input on every step of the process of optimizing the client relationship (Oppioli et al., 2023). The use of AI-powered predictive analytics in management consulting has already made its way into the market (Kaczorowska-Spychalska et al., 2024). Figure 2 illustrates how artificial intelligence has had a profound impact on the field of management consulting. Figure 2 illustrates how artificial intelligence may be able to help firms make more informed decisions, streamline operations, and offer custom solutions to their clients (Mohan, 2024). In an increasingly competitive marketplace, management consulting will be better positioned to improve efficiency and innovate. With AI, consultants can gather a greater amount of data and process more of it in a shorter period of time (Korzynski et al., 2023). The use of AI can also be used to determine efficiencies, market demand, forecast productivity, and prices as well as analyze market demand (Kaczorowska-Spychalska et al., 2024). As a management consultant, one of your constant goals is to increase profits and productivity for your clients. Clients can get more done if AI is combined with the services of management consultants (Oppioli et al., 2023). AI in management consulting combines real-time insight with a variable rate technology and best practices for data management to maximize profits and productivity for clients (Mohan, 2024). A management consulting company can use AI in order to gain real-time insights, thus assisting them in identifying which areas need attention, resulting in considerable savings in the long run (Korzynski et al., 2023).

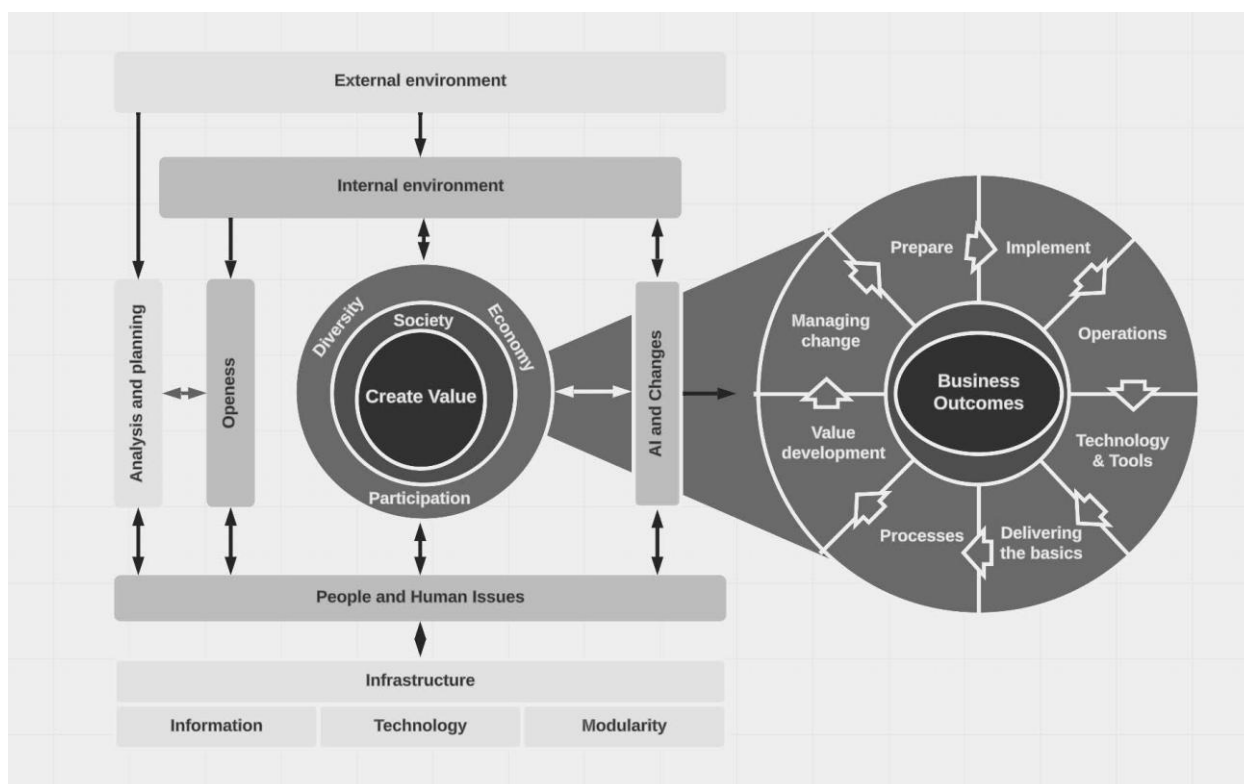


Figure 1 Managing change in the world of management consultants with artificial intelligence.

4. AI in Management Consulting: Negatives, Risks, and Barriers

It is important to pay attention to a number of issues, risks, and barriers associated with integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into management consulting. Potential job displacement is a primary concern. The work of the future will be to create better jobs as a result of the advent of intelligent machines (Mindell & Reynolds, 2023). Artificial intelligence (AI) systems are becoming increasingly sophisticated and are likely to result in a large wave of job displacement in the near future. A middle path is crucial in this situation. The role and responsibilities of the management consultant may undergo some changes (Kaczorowska-Spychalska et al., 2024). Many new jobs will also be created as a result of the advent of artificial intelligence (Mohan, 2024). The jobs of the future will look very different from those of today (Oppioli et al., 2023). There may be a need to create another category of responsibilities within the role of management consultant, such as explainer (Korzynski et al., 2023). By imbibing the explainer trait, management consultants will contribute to bridging the gap between technology output and business results (Mohan, 2024). The new role of explainers will enable management consultants to provide clarity on AI results, which is becoming increasingly important as AI systems become more opaque (Oppioli et al., 2023). Artificial intelligence's efficiency in data analysis and problem-solving may reduce the need for human consultants, resulting in a reduction in employment opportunities (Kaczorowska-Spychalska et al., 2024).

While it is apparent that many management consulting firms and individual management consultants are eager to enhance their operations through the use of advanced technological solutions, the journey to achieving this goal is not without

its challenges. Incorporating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into management consulting presents several challenges. It is particularly important to grasp the full implications of using artificial intelligence, determine the optimal investment in time and financial resources, and procure the necessary expertise (Kaczorowska-Spychalska et al., 2024). The adoption of artificial intelligence may also lead to resistance and skepticism on the part of clients and employees. It is possible that these clients and stakeholders are concerned about the reliability of AI and its impact on traditional management consulting practices (Oarue-Itseuwa, 2024). Based on the results of the research conducted on the impact of artificial intelligence on the consulting industry, it can be concluded that implementing Artificial Intelligence in consulting practices is not an easy task, and that it can have a significant impact inducing economic and organizational impacts (Alexandre et al., 2020). To successfully navigate these challenges, it is imperative to plan carefully, communicate transparently, and implement change management strategies that are strategic in nature. In order to ensure a smooth transition, it is critical that management consultants not only focus on the technological aspects, but also on the human aspects involved in adopting AI. This will ensure that the benefits of AI are maximized while disruptions and resistance are minimized. In consulting, AI programs can help reduce administrative tasks or do accurate and rapid analysis, but they also come with limitations and ethical risks (Gînguță et al., 2023). Figure 3 illustrates some of the major obstacles to the implementation of artificial intelligence in management consulting. The factors shown in Figure 3 include concerns about data privacy, resistance to change, a lack of AI expertise, and the difficulty of integrating AI technologies into existing workflows. By removing these barriers, AI can maximize its potential in the field of management consulting.

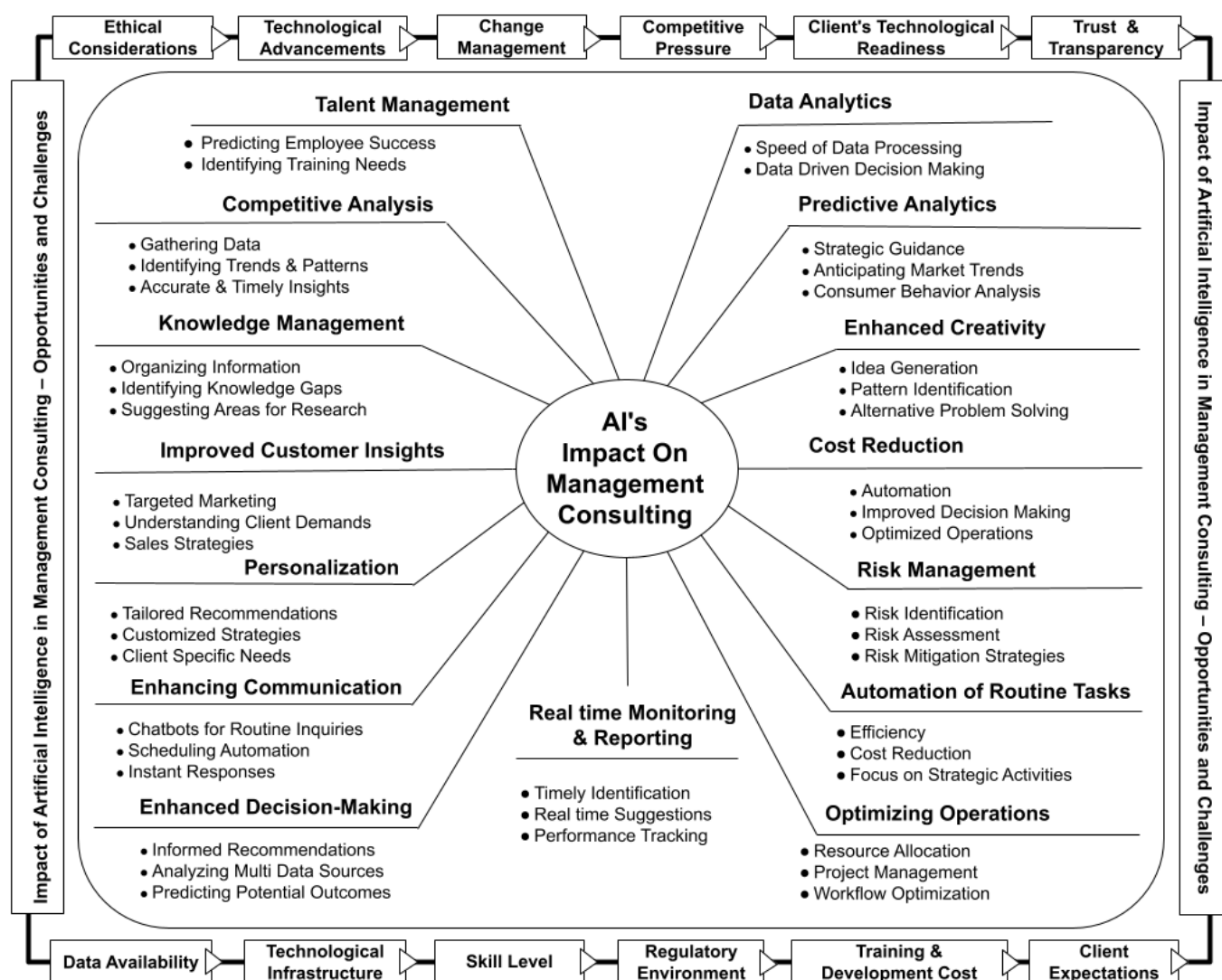


Figure 2 AI's impact on management consulting.

Artificial intelligence (AI) is helping management consultants do fast, precise analyses, which improves efficiency drastically. Having AI handle big datasets, provide insight, and automate routine processes allows strategic decisions to be made with ease. Technology has many advantages, but it also has some disadvantages. Artificial intelligence (AI) systems are limited by the quality and scope of input data, so they can be inaccurate or biased. There's also the privacy issue, algorithmic transparency, and job displacement. Artificial intelligence offers exciting opportunities for management consulting, but it also

has some limitations and ethical implications. Both clients and consultancies benefit and suffer from digital transformation of management consulting, and it needs better regulation and standardization. There needs to be more regulation and standardization in consulting (Mamedova et al., 2022). AI decisions may also have ethical implications, which is another critical risk. In spite of their proficiency in data processing, AI systems do not possess human empathy or an understanding of ethical nuances, which could lead to decisions that are technically sound but morally problematic. Generative artificial intelligence technologies have significant effects on partial job displacement and productivity growth (Lazaroïu & Rogalska, 2023).

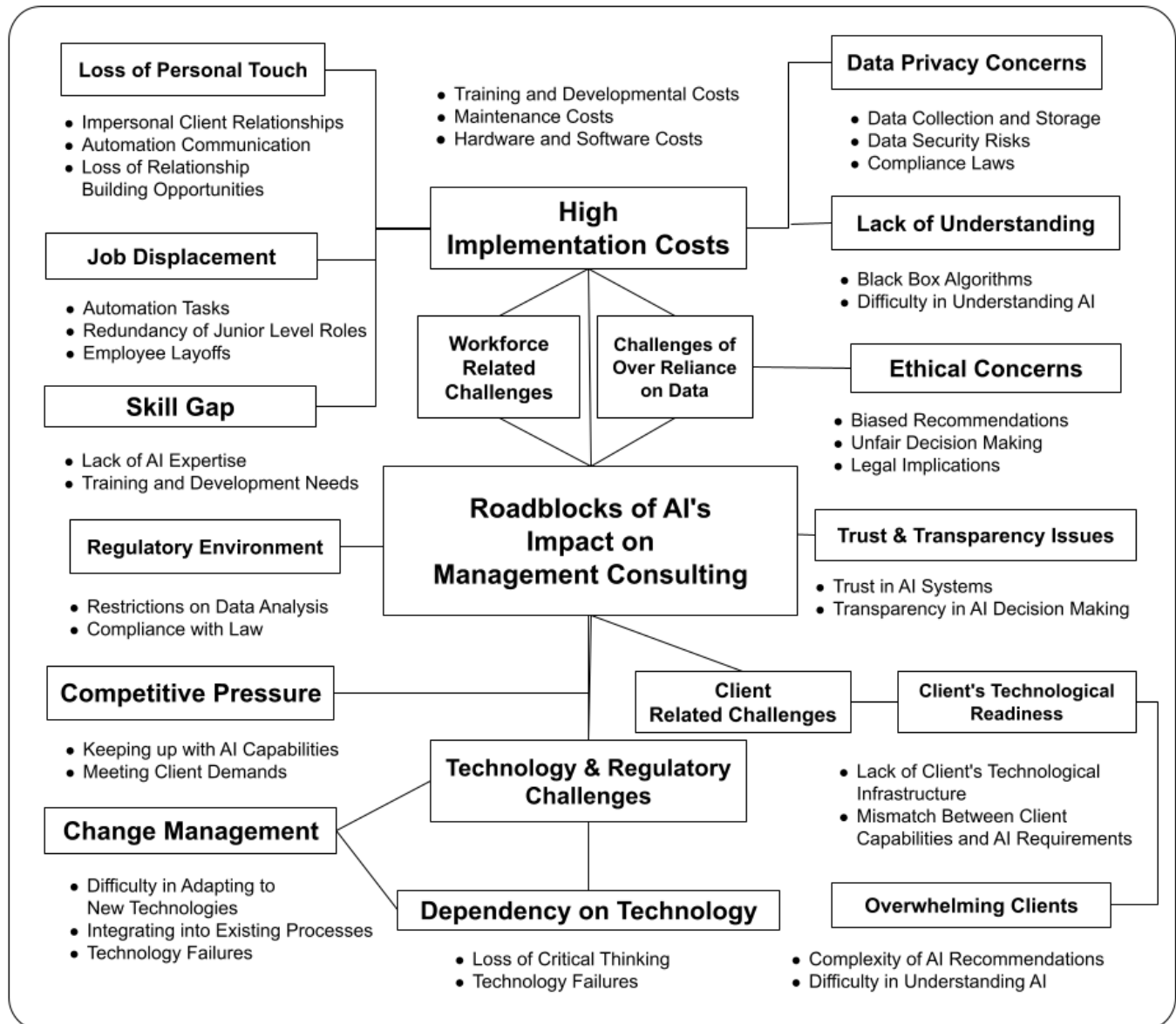


Figure 3 Roadblocks of ai's impact on management consulting.

A further concern related to the privacy and security of data is presented by AI's reliance on data. Management consulting firms handle sensitive information of their clients, and AI systems, which are vulnerable to hacking and data breaches, may compromise the confidentiality of their clients (Keding, 2021). This risk highlights the importance of robust data governance frameworks to mitigate potential breaches (Alvarez & Marsal, 2023).

A bias or incomplete data set can adversely affect decisions, resulting in flawed AI-generated advice (Mohan, 2024). Such issues underscore the need for high-quality, representative datasets to ensure fair and accurate outcomes (EY, 2023). A substantial investment is required to implement AI in management consulting. The costs of these services may be prohibitive for smaller consulting firms, creating a digital divide within the industry (Samokhvalov, 2024). Hidden costs, including those associated with compliance and liability, further complicate the financial landscape (Forbes, 2023).

As AI systems become more complex, specialized skills are required for their operation and interpretation, necessitating the training and development of management consultants (Oarue-Itseuwa et al., 2024). Firms must prioritize skill-building

initiatives to ensure effective AI integration (Forbes, 2023). The final issue is that of AI transparency and explainability. Management consultants may find it difficult to explain the reasoning behind certain recommendations made by AI algorithms to clients due to their complexity and opaque nature (Keding, 2021). This lack of transparency can erode client trust, which is fundamental to the consulting industry (Gartner, 2023). Client relationships, which are essential to the consulting industry, can be harmed by this lack of transparency. Although artificial intelligence provides opportunities for innovation in management consulting, its negative aspects, risks, and barriers must be carefully managed to ensure its ethical, secure, and effective application (Alvarez & Marsal, 2023). The role of representative datasets in addressing bias and ensuring fair decisions cannot be overstated (EY, 2023).

5. Management Consulting Opportunities: Direct AI Sales Versus Incorporating AI Into Operations and Services

This paper presents a scoping review summarizing information about the metadata description implemented in the digital As artificial intelligence (AI) becomes more prevalent, the management consulting landscape is undergoing a significant transformation, offering distinct opportunities. For starters, selling AI solutions as a straightforward service involves providing clients with AI technologies or systems directly. This approach is mainly focused on providing clients with AI tools or platforms, in which case the management consulting firm acts as a vendor. Since the sale of AI technology is a clear-cut transaction, this model is relatively straightforward. AI is more challenging and nuanced when it is applied to enhance other services or within a management consulting firm itself. By integrating artificial intelligence into various management consulting services, they can improve efficiency, decision-making, and provide deeper insights (Prytula, 2024). AI can be used to enhance management consulting services, for instance to analyze markets, assess risks, and predict customer behavior. An understanding of both the client's industry and the AI technology is necessary for this kind of application in management consulting, as well as a strategic approach to the implementation of the technology.

Figure 4 provides an overview of the timeline and future predictions for the integration of artificial intelligence (AI) in management consulting, illustrating the evolution of AI across four distinct phases. In the past (2000s–2010s), artificial intelligence has been used primarily to analyze basic and descriptive data (NMS Consulting, 2024). It was also used to develop early chatbots for client interaction (Keding, 2021). AI in the past was employed to automate routine tasks and perform foundational predictive modeling (Samokhvalov, 2024). The current state of artificial intelligence (AI) allows for real-time advanced data analytics (Greenlight Consulting, 2024). It also supports prescriptive insights and the automation of complex tasks and decision-making (Samokhvalov, 2024). A number of advanced predictive modeling functions are available, such as scenario analysis and employee assessment (Keystride, 2024). Personalized client interaction and market analysis for strategic planning are also facilitated by AI advancements (Mohan, 2024). Among the future predictions (2020–2030s) are the identification and mitigation of real-time risks (Forrester, 2024). Enhanced competitive analysis and the organization of knowledge are also expected (Oarue-Itseuwa, 2024). Furthermore, AI will likely aid in the development of new insights to inform strategic decisions (Samokhvalov, 2024). As AI develops in the future (2030s and beyond), the process of collecting, analyzing, and making decisions is expected to be fully automated (Stransact, 2024). The long-term future of AI and management consulting is projected to foster innovation through the generation of ideas (Keding, 2021). It is also anticipated to support the development of creative solutions and the creation of entirely new business models (Greenlight Consulting, 2024). The timeline covered in Figure 4 illustrates the growing impact of artificial intelligence, from improving operational efficiency (NMS Consulting, 2024) to driving strategic innovation in management consulting (Keding, 2021).

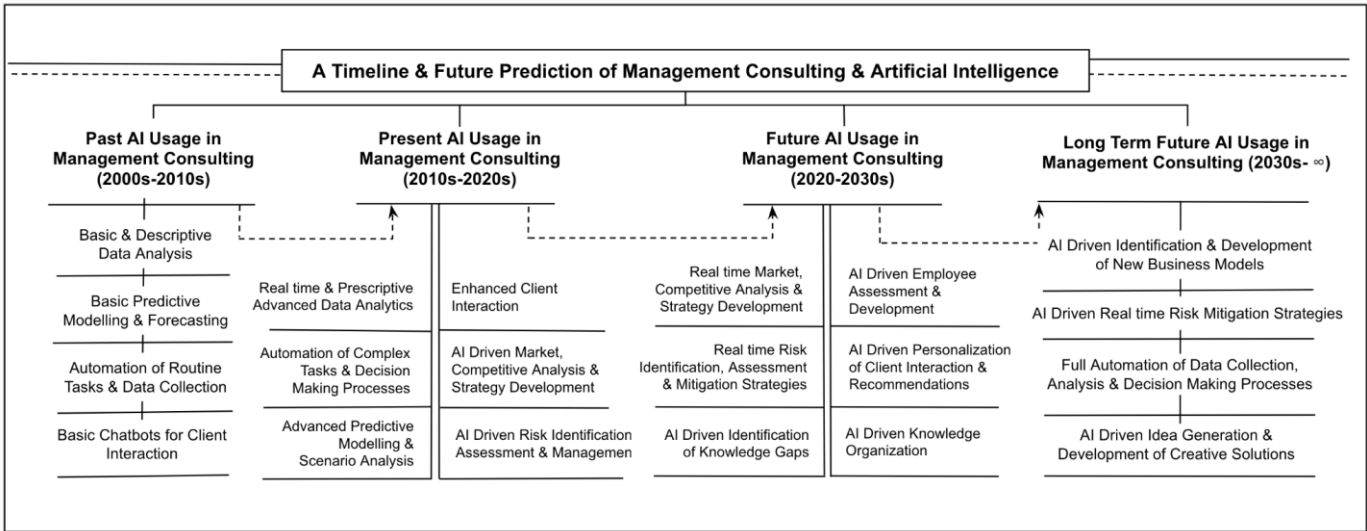


Figure 4 A Timeline & future prediction of management consulting & artificial intelligence.

At present, the market offers a wide range of AI tools (e.g. ClickUp AI, ChatGPT, AskCodi, Document AI, Bard) and there are additional advanced tools scheduled for release in the near future that should significantly benefit management consultants. Management consulting organizations need to reevaluate existing workflows, upskill staff, and possibly undergo a cultural shift in order to use AI internally. The management consulting industry must adapt its operational models to take advantage of AI effectively, which can include automating routine tasks, improving data analysis capabilities, or even implementing AI for internal decision-making (Kamaruddin, 2023). The sale of AI solutions represents a direct, transactional opportunity, but the application of AI to other services or internally requires a more complex, strategic approach, which requires a deeper integration of technology with business processes and a holistic transformation of operational methodologies.

6. Assessing and considering the challenges

To keep the AI race from becoming reckless in management consulting, it is necessary to set up and create a set of rules, as well as enforce legal guardrails. The reality is that dealing with the velocity of huge challenges requires a great deal of focus and agility. The entire management consulting community must come together and take the lead on creating a system that can handle these huge challenges (Shafiabady et al., 2023). There is also a challenge when it comes to deploying AI in the field of management consulting in terms of data quality and accuracy. As AI is able to learn more accurately when provided with large amounts of well-structured data, if a consultant's datasets are not reliable or inconsistent, the accuracy of results may not be as accurate as it could be. A management consultant should focus on data quality, data monitoring, and data availability if they are going to overcome these challenges when it comes to data management (Oyewo & Tran, 2021). The way to do this is by tagging data with attributes that will make it easier for AI systems to process the data. Changes should be monitored by management consultants, and testing should be done regularly to see how these changes affect existing AI models, so that management consultants can react quickly when a model needs to be rebuilt or redesigned as a result of the changes.

Due to the fact that AI is a multifaceted capability when it comes to management consulting, generalising regulations will, in some instances, overregulate and in others, underregulate. A question that has remained unanswered by policymakers for decades has to do with how the personal information of individuals should be dealt with in the digital age. Such a question is nothing new for technology in the digital age (Sun et al., 2025).

7. Future Considerations

Consulting plays a pivotal role in the contemporary economic landscape (Malikova & Abduganieva, 2023). The use of artificial intelligence has become so ubiquitous in our everyday lives, from facial recognition to language translators and personal assistants like Siri and Alexa, that we barely notice it anymore. Besides these consumer applications, companies across sectors are increasingly harnessing the power of artificial intelligence to improve their operational efficiency. AI has the potential to be a significant asset for businesses and economies as it contributes to the development of productivity growth and innovation. However, there is no doubt that Artificial Intelligence's impact on work will be profound at the same time. A number of occupations including data analysts in management consulting as well as the demand for some skills will decrease, whereas others will grow and a number of people will change as they work alongside ever-evolving and increasingly capable machines. The examination of previous research exploring the intricacies of how automation technologies influence employment reveals that this relationship is notably intricate and multifaceted (Filippi et al., 2023).

As far as jobs and the world of management consulting are concerned, there are two sides to this story. On one hand, artificial intelligence is going to take away some of the regular jobs that management consultants do, but on the other hand, it will also create new ones as a result of AI (Bessen, 2018). The lower-skilled regions, which tend to be more vulnerable to job loss due to their weakened economies and high unemployment rates, are the ones with weaker economies and a higher unemployment rate. As a matter of fact, there are some subfields within the management consulting profession that could still benefit from the advancements of AI in the future, but AI is not able to replicate the empathy and social intelligence that management consultants require on a day-to-day basis (Gromulski & Ericson, 2024). As of right now, it is impossible to predict how many jobs will be replaced by AI or what types of jobs will be affected (Deming et al., 2025). However, jobs that require human touch within the consulting industry will continue to evolve and AI will not be able to replace them. In spite of the fact that Artificial Intelligence will be disruptive to the way management consultants work, we should also think about the potential benefits of higher productivity work and cheaper to run services, as well as the risk of falling behind if other consulting firms and economies better adapt to technological change and AI (Agrawat & Deshani, 2025).

8. Will AI Make Management Consultants Redundant?

The advent of generative AI will revolutionize the consulting industry and other industries across the globe (Karulkar et al., 2025). There is a need for the consortium for management consulting and professional bodies to build and implement AI governance frameworks in order to ensure that this transformation with respect to management consulting is fair and that it works for all (Batool et al., 2025). Artificial intelligence employs a number of techniques to transform vast amounts of data to

generate a variety of content across a range of media, combining human-like creativity with technological efficiency. As this emerging field evolves, there is a wealth of opportunities for management consultants to revolutionise the way they work across the industry by automating tasks, fostering creativity, and improving decision-making, thus equipping them with the tools to advance their work (Chen et al., 2022). A future consideration is that it also raises a number of challenges, ranging from ethical considerations and notions of fairness to more deep-seated debates about intelligence, as well as fears regarding the reaching of the technological singularity, a hypothetical future where technology becomes uncontrollable, which is what presents the emerging gaps and challenges (Lambert & Stevens, 2024). There may be potential risks associated with this in the future. There are many potential consequences, including the displacement of jobs, malicious exploitation, misalignment of human values, as well as concerns regarding intellectual property rights, ownership and open versus closed systems. Several other issues relating to management consulting and artificial intelligence need to be addressed, including how to balance innovation with safety, the tension between multilingual language systems and sovereign national language systems, and others (Holgersson et al., 2024). In terms of management consulting and AI, in terms of future research, the future research would focus on professional training for management consultants, which was neglected at the beginning and so needs to be given due attention for future research. It is important to realize that the concept of artificial intelligence is very broad and needs to be streamlined for use in management consulting. It represents a very large area for future research in the field. A pedagogical approach to AI ethics for management consulting is another future research aspect that needs to be considered as part of the implementation of AI ethics (Noroozi et al., 2024). In order for artificial intelligence to succeed as a tool for solving problems, management consultants need to be in charge of the AI operation, direct it, and understand that the results of the process must improve the overall performance of management consulting. The current AI technology is still far from being capable of engaging in management consulting in a full-fledged manner, applying common sense to make decisions, or handling consulting errors on a full-fledged basis (Hirsch-Kreinsen, 2024). Sometimes, the presence of AI is imperceptible to customers and these simulations will help management consulting to gain a deeper understanding of the marriage of management consulting and artificial intelligence (Belanche et al., 2024).

9. Conclusion

Despite the advancement of artificial intelligence, there will always be jobs that can never be replaced by it. A lot of the jobs that AI will never be able to replicate range from creative fields to empathic positions as well as complex strategic jobs that management consultants do on a day-to-day basis. Also, in the upcoming years there will be a demand for human management consultants to help us adapt to a new world where AI will have a larger role to play. There is a pressing need for people who are capable of understanding artificial intelligence and are able to implement it in order to facilitate the adoption of technology so that it reduces workloads rather than increasing them. The process of modernizing existing infrastructure is quite a challenge for all management consultants, whether they are small or medium sized management consulting firms or even for larger management consulting firms

The pandemic has accelerated this process as many organizations are already making strides in the direction of digital transformation. Besides the AI tools themselves, the technology infrastructure that supports AI extends and powers well beyond the basic AI tools themselves. Throughout the process, deployment, performance feedback, as well as self-services are included. A consultant can maximize the benefits of AI by properly deploying AI applications designed with a comprehensive way to collect feedback at every stage of the development process through a comprehensive feedback collection process. One of AI's biggest advantages for management consultants is the fact that it will free them from performing repetitive, tedious tasks that are part of their overall duties, so they can focus more on the more complex and rewarding projects that are part of their daily roles.

Ethical Considerations

Not applicable.

Conflict of Interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

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